

DEAN'S POLICY AND OPERATING MEMORANDUM 03 - 10

OFFICE OF THE DEAN
UNITED STATES MILITARY
ACADEMY
West Point, New York 10996-5000

MADN

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USMA ROTATING MILITARY FACULTY SELECTION

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1. Purpose. This DPOM prescribes policies and procedures governing the qualifications, selection, and special education requirements of officer instructors and their assignment to academic departments at the United States Military Academy (USMA).

2. Applicability. These policies and procedures apply to departments, centers and other organizations that are responsible for the screening, selection, and assignment of active-duty Army officers to the staff and faculty at USMA.

3. Exemptions. Departments who have career military field specific faculty assigned directly by a branch/functional area manager (e.g., Judge Advocate General, Medical Service Corps) are exempt from board procedures. Additionally, departments that use the Army Talent Alignment Process for select functional area positions (e.g., Acquisition Corps officers on the Military Acquisition Program List, Foreign Area Officers) will follow the Army's talent matching process.

4. Qualifications. Officers interested in becoming instructors for the

academic departments should meet the below general qualifications. These qualifications can be waived by Department Heads for especially talented candidates who are approved for assignment by Army Human Resources Command (AHRC).

- a. Completed a minimum of four years of commissioned service.
- b. Completed at least six but not more than thirteen years of active service at the time of assignment to USMA.
- c. Completed a Key Developmental (KD) assignment at their current rank; in many branches, this requires successful completion of company command.
- d. Completed a minimum of the Captain's Career Course for Captains and Intermediate Level Education for Majors.
- e. Possess special aptitude for a specific subject to be taught.
- f. Demonstrate qualities of leadership, excellent character, military bearing, and appearance.
- g. Demonstrate potential for continued service on active duty upon completion of the USMA teaching assignment.
- h. Possess any special qualifications announced by the Dean of the Academic Board and the USMA Superintendent.

5. Selection. There are two steps in the instructor selection process for assignment to USMA: candidate identification and application review.

a. Candidate Identification. There are several ways to identify potential instructors.

(1) Departments initiate files on cadets who have demonstrated potential to become instructors.

(2) Departments query Army personnel databases to identify officers with undergraduate degrees related to each department's discipline.

(3) Department Heads correspond with professors of military science across the country to solicit nominations.

(4) Veteran instructors returning to the field refer outstanding junior officers to various departments.

(5) Department Heads visit AHRC to search for and discuss potential

instructors.

(6) Candidates apply through the Talent Based Career Alignment program.

(7) Candidates may declare their interests in a West Point assignment at any time by applying online through TEACH, a software application providing a paperless, online system for identifying, screening and processing applications from faculty candidates. TEACH allows candidates to review their status and make updates to their applications in "real time." Note that TEACH is a replacement for the legacy systems known as WEST and EAST.

b. Application Review. Each officer applicant must have a KD assignment in their current grade before AHRC will support a nominative assignment at West Point. The basic criteria for KD assignments are defined by branch and functional area in the DA Pam 600-3 Smartbook.

(1) Departments screen and select officers whose timelines permit their assignment to USMA between their sixth and thirteenth year of service. Departments are required to ensure that candidates meet branch or functional area key and developmental position requirements at their current grade and that they will have sufficient time to meet key and developmental requirements at their next higher grade to remain competitive for future promotion boards.

(2) Departments will form a selection committee of at least three personnel to review candidate files. The selection committee will consider the qualifications of each officer and determine an order of merit list for selection. Department Heads will not be members of these selection committees as they serve as the final decision-making authority. In cases where the Department Head is not able to be the selection decision authority, the Deputy Department Head will fulfill this role.

(3) Based upon the criteria outlined in the Joint Ethics Regulation and the Code of Federal Regulations - DoD 5500 .07-R, section 2-200 through 2-207, which incorporates the Standards of Conduct for Employees of the Executive Branch, Title 5 Code of Federal Regulations Part 2635 (5 C.F.R. 2635) - any individual involved in the selection committee and/or decision process with any possible conflicts of interest will recuse themselves from the panel in order to avoid any appearances of partiality.

(4) Prior to the selection committee reviewing the candidate files, the Department Head, or their designated representative who is not a member of the selection committee, will remove all candidate letters of recommendation that are from an individual who is either a member of the selection committee

or part of any selection committee member's rating chain. Department Heads will also remove any letters they feel may introduce favoritism and undue influence into the selection process.

(5) Once the Department Head approves the selections, the department will submit the names of the primary and alternate officers to the Dean's Human Resources (HR) Branch for the "Blue Book" review by the published deadline. This deadline is generally in January, but the date will vary depending on AHRC's timeline. HR Branch will screen and consolidate the list, coordinate with departments for any clarification or corrections, and submit the consolidated list to AHRC. AHRC will review each candidate to determine if the candidate's career timeline and manner of performance merit assignment at USMA. AHRC will provide concurrence, tentative concurrence, or non-concurrence for each officer. Based on the AHRC review, Department Heads will make final selections for the faculty, and/or request reconsideration for officers who received a non-concurrence based on inaccurate rationale. The Dean can request reconsideration with AHRC, but AHRC makes the final determination on assignments.

6. Graduate Education.

a. Any person assigned to serve as the lead instructor for a section of cadets at USMA must possess at least a master's degree (or equivalent) in a relevant academic discipline. The gaining department's Department Head may set parameters on the acceptable type of graduate degree in terms of academic discipline studied and type of institution at which the degree is earned.

b. Some direct assignments are made to the USMA faculty if the officer already has the requisite degree, is otherwise qualified with his/her branch, and is acceptable to the department concerned.

c. For those who have not yet obtained a qualifying graduate degree, following selection, the officer will normally attend a 21-month Advanced Civil Schooling (ACS) graduate program in an area related to the gaining department's discipline. Graduate programs of less than 21-months require the Dean's approval prior to submitting the ACS packet to AHRC.

d. If selected for an approved doctoral program, faculty members may attend a graduate program for up to 36 months in residence. These faculty members will have an additional 24 months, as necessary, not in residence to complete their doctorate while serving as USMA faculty.

7. Types of Assignment. There are two types of assignments to USMA: direct hire and ACS.

a. Direct assignments are given to officers who already have acquired the appropriate graduate education required for a particular discipline. If there are multiple qualified candidates, the department will follow the same process outlined in Section 4 (Selection). These officers will serve a three-year tour at USMA. Tour extensions or curtailments will be granted as an exception to policy and will require approval by the Dean and AHRC.

b. Assignments following ACS are given to those officers not academically qualified at the time of selection and nomination. Officers attending ACS prior to their USMA assignment are required to complete 36 months of utilization in the academic discipline studied. Exceptions require approval by the Dean and AHRC.

8. Special Considerations.

a. Officers educated and trained for positions in other Army educational programs may be assigned to USMA instructor positions provided they are not needed in specific functional areas for which they were trained. Assignment to the USMA faculty is a professionally rewarding and career-enhancing assignment provided the timing of this assignment is well planned. AHRC continues its efforts to ensure that upon departure from a USMA assignment, officers are integrated back within career patterns and other professional development assignments and, where possible, the follow-on assignment is with a troop unit.

b. Faculty assignments for military lawyers in the Department of Law and Philosophy (DLP) are made by the Personnel, Plans, and Training Office of the Judge Advocate General (JAG). DLP will coordinate directly with JAG for reassignment and replacement of military lawyers on the USMA faculty.

9. Department Policies. These policies and procedures represent the minimum standard to which departments, centers, and organizations will adhere when selecting military faculty. All departments, centers, and organizations must develop and publish their own standard operating procedures (SOP) for faculty selection and maintain a copy on file within the department. The Dean's HR Branch will maintain a copy of the Department Selection SOPs and review them on an annual basis. Department SOPs will address the following areas.

a. Establish the minimum standard for the formation, composition and operation of faculty selection committees.

b. Specify the Department Head as the final decision authority.

c. Require formal appointment of selection committee members via formal memorandum.

- d. Identify items required in candidate application packets.
- e. Outline department's criteria for accepting letters of recommendation.
- f. Address reasons why individuals involved in the selection committee and/or decision process must recuse themselves.

10. References.

- a. Army Regulation 614-100, Officer Assignment Policies and Procedures.
- b. Army Regulation 621-1, Advanced Education Programs and Requirements for Military Personnel.
- c. DA Pamphlet 600-3, Commissioned Officer Professional Development and Career Management.
- d. Standards of Conduct for Employees of the Executive Branch, Title 5 Code of Federal Regulations Part 2635 (5 C.F.R. 2635).
- e. Review and Analysis of USMA Selection Policies and Procedures for Advanced Civil Schooling and Follow-On Utilization Assignment at USMA, LTG B. C. Freakley (dated 12 May 2010).

11. Proponent. The proponent for this Dean's policy and operating memorandum is the HR Branch, Office of the Dean.

FOR THE DEAN OF THE ACADEMIC BOARD:

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Vice Dean for Operations